

VPC Mapping Tool — Quickstart

v0.8.8 · May 2026 · One sheet for field operators. Open **VPC Mapping Tool.html** in Chrome, Edge, or Safari.

1. Open & find your site

No install. Network helps for map tiles, address search, and PDF export libraries.

Fresh start every open: The map opens empty at the default view. Your last layout is *not* loaded automatically. After a refresh or new tab, click **Restore Autosave** (same browser) or **Open Plan** (JSON file).

Offline: Enter (lat, lng) in search (e.g. (34.05, -118.25)) and press **Search**. Layout editing works; tiles may not load.

- 1. Search by address/place, or paste coordinates.
- 2. **Setup ▾** — set **Operation Name** (print/PDF) and scale presets if needed.
- 3. Layer control (top-right): satellite + **Place Labels (Hybrid)** for orientation.

2. Place & edit structures

- 1. **Vendor** tab → click a model (enters place mode).
- 2. Click the map to place. Repeat for more structures.
- 3. Click a placed object — drag body to move; **orange handle** to rotate ((Shift) = 5° steps).
- 4. Delete: red X on map, X in placed list, or (Shift)+click footprint — all ask to confirm.
- 5. **Custom Size** — enter dimensions → **Place Custom** → click map.

Attach structures (snap)

- 1. Select the target structure on the map.
- 2. Check **Snap to selected object** in Label & Style.
- 3. Pick the add-on model, click near the face to attach (nearest of four faces wins).
- 4. Snap **unchecks automatically** after a successful attach. Best for rect-to-rect.

3. Spacing & overlaps

Options ▾ — set **clearance buffer** (feet) for dashed setback rings on the *next* placement, or use presets / Apply Buffer to All.

Signal	Meaning	Action
Red	Footprints physically overlap	Move or rotate — must fix
Amber	Clearance rings conflict (footprints may still be separate)	Adjust spacing, or check Intentional in placed list (amber-only rows)

Watch the status bar, sidebar warning under **Placed**, and the map **pill** (top-right). Click the pill to jump to the first flagged structure.

4. Header tools

- **Undo / Redo** — up to 50 steps ((Ctrl)+Z / (Y); Mac: (Cmd)+Z). Cleared on refresh — use Save Plan or Restore Autosave.
- **Measure ▾** — distance or area on the map.
- **Autosaved ...** — timestamp for browser backup; **Restore Autosave** loads it (confirms if layout already has structures).

5. Save, export & print

- **Save Plan** — portable JSON (archive, email, reopen on any machine).
- **Open Plan** — replaces current layout (confirms).
- **Export ▾** — GeoJSON (GIS) or PDF (map snapshot + summary; needs network for libraries).
- **Print Fit** — frames all structures; enable *Print background graphics* for satellite imagery.

Autosave ≠ backup: Autosave stays in this browser only. Save Plan files for operations handoff.

6. Keyboard shortcuts

- (F) — focus search
- (P) — place selected tent
- (Esc) — return to view mode (or click mode badge)
- (Ctrl)+Z / (Y) — undo / redo

Hover controls in the app for more hints (title tooltips on buttons, sliders, and map objects).

App: VPC Mapping Tool.html · **Docs:** README.md, VPC_Project_Notes.md · **Version:** 0.8.8 (2026-05-19)
To print this sheet: File → Print, or save as PDF. Re-export **VPC Mapping Tool - Quickstart.pdf** after editing this HTML.